

SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA, CONTRA COSTA COUNTY  
MARTINEZ, CA  
DEPARTMENT 16  
JUDICIAL OFFICER: BENJAMIN T. REYES II  
HEARING DATE: 05/27/2026

**INSTRUCTIONS FOR CONTESTING TENTATIVE RULING IN  
DEPARTMENT 16**

The tentative ruling will become the ruling of the Court unless by 4:00 P.M. of the Court day preceding the hearing, notice is given of an intent to argue the matter. Counsel or self-represented parties must email Department 16 ([Dept16@contracosta.courts.ca.gov](mailto:Dept16@contracosta.courts.ca.gov)) to request argument and **must specify, in detail, what provision(s) of the tentative ruling they intend to argue and why**. Counsel or self-represented parties requesting argument must advise all other counsel and self-represented parties by no later than 4:00 P.M. of their decision to argue, and of the issues to be argued. Failure to timely advise the Court and counsel or self-represented parties will preclude any party from arguing the matter. (Pursuant to Local Rule 3.43(2).)

The prevailing party must prepare and e-file a proposed order after hearing in accordance with CRC 3.1312. The order must include appearances. If the tentative ruling becomes the Court's ruling, a copy of the Court's tentative ruling **must be attached to the proposed order** when submitted to the Court for issuance of the order.

ALL APPEARANCES TO ARGUE WILL BE IN PERSON OR BY ZOOM, PROVIDED THAT PROPER NOTIFICATION IS RECEIVED BY THE DEPARTMENT AS PER ABOVE.

Zoom link-

<https://www.zoomgov.com/j/1619504895?pwd=NOV1N3JFRnJ0TEVoSDNrTGRzakF3UT09>

**ID: 161 950 4895**

**Password: 812674**

**Courtroom Clerk's Session**

**1. 8:31 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-02285**  
**CASE NAME: DARRIN OHLHAUSER VS. TAILGATERS SPORTS BAR & GRILL**  
**\*FURTHER CASE MANAGEMENT CONFERENCE TO TRAIL MOTION (ON ORDER SUBSTITUTING SUCCESSOR IN INTEREST)**  
**FILED BY:**  
**\*TENTATIVE RULING:\***

This Case Management Conference trails the hearing on Line 9. The matter is unopposed. This CMC is continued to November 23, 2026 at 8:30 a.m. The Parties are ordered to meet and confer to discuss Alternative Dispute Resolution and to provide a further update to the Court on their efforts to resolve this case. No appearance is required on May 27, 2026.

**2. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-02414**  
**CASE NAME: DELLYON ROBINSON VS. FCI LENDER SERVICES, INC.**  
**\*CASE MANAGEMENT CONFERENCE**

**FILED BY:**

**\*TENTATIVE RULING:\***

This Case Management Conference trails the hearing on Line 10. If the tentative ruling is not contested, this CMC is continued to November 23, 2026 at 8:30 a.m. The Parties are ordered to meet and confer to discuss Alternative Dispute Resolution and to provide a further update to the Court on their efforts to resolve this case.

**3. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-02896**  
**CASE NAME: STEVEN SMITH VS. DONALD IWUCHUKWU**  
**\*CASE MANAGEMENT CONFERENCE**

**FILED BY:**

**\*TENTATIVE RULING:\***

This Case Management Conference trails the hearing on Line 12. If the tentative ruling is not contested, this CMC is continued to November 23, 2026 at 8:30 a.m. The Parties are ordered to meet and confer to discuss Alternative Dispute Resolution and to provide a further update to the Court on their efforts to resolve this case.

**4. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-02896**  
**CASE NAME: STEVEN SMITH VS. DONALD IWUCHUKWU**  
**HEARING ON ORDER TO SHOW CAUSE IN RE: WHY CHRISTIAN ANYIAM SHOULD NOT BE HELD IN CONTEMPT FOR FAILURE TO APPEAR AT THE 4/23/2026 CASE MANAGEMENT CONFERENCE**  
**FILED BY:**

**\*TENTATIVE RULING:\***

Respondent Steven Smith, trustee of Patricia Byrd Canson Living Trust's, ("Respondent") *Ex Parte* Application for Order to Show Cause why Donald Iwuchuku, Christian Anyiam, and Metu Ogike should not be found in contempt for preparing and offering false evidence to the Court is **reserved** as a trial issue to be determined by the trier of fact. Per the Court's Order on April 20, 2026, a contempt citation is not the proper way to resolve allegations of false evidence. The Court will not rule on this matter on May 27, 2026. This hearing is **vacated**.

**5. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C25-02721**  
**CASE NAME: LUIS ARMENTA GOMEZ VS. PREYANKA KANDA**  
**\*CASE MANAGEMENT CONFERENCE**

**FILED BY:**

**\*TENTATIVE RULING:\***

This Case Management Conference trails the hearing on Line 17. If the tentative ruling is not contested, this CMC is continued to November 23, 2026 at 8:30 a.m. The Parties are ordered to meet and confer to discuss Alternative Dispute Resolution and to provide a further update to the Court on their efforts to resolve this case.